Table 6.1 Basic Principles and Methods of Food Preservation		
S.No.	**Basic principles**	**Methods of food preservation**
1	Proper handling of food stuffs and creating hygienic environment	Keeping away from microorganisms (Asepsis)
2	Destruction or inactivation of food enzymes	Blanching, pressure cooking and sterilization
3	Changing the temperature that spoil food	Refrigeration, freezing methods and using high temperature
4	Removal of moisture and water from food	Complete and partial drying
5	Removal of air	Canning, bottling and vacuum packing
6	Changing the pH value that causes food spoilage	Addition of salt, sugar and chemical preservatives

Principles of Food Preservation

I. Prevention or delay of microbial decomposition

a) By keeping away undesirable micro-organisms. (**Eg:** asepsis)
b) By removal of microorganisms. (**Eg:** filtration)
c) By hindering the growth and activity of microorganisms. **Eg:** refrigeration, drying, dehydration, addition of chemical preservatives.
d) By killing the microorganisms. **Eg:** by heat or radiation

II. Prevention or delay of self-decomposition of food

a) By destruction or inactivation of enzymes **Eg:** by blanching.
b) By prevention or delaying the chemical reactions. **Eg:** prevention of oxidation using lime juice/citric acid.

III. Prevention of damage caused by insects, animals and mechanical causes

The details of basic principles and methods of food preservation are given below:

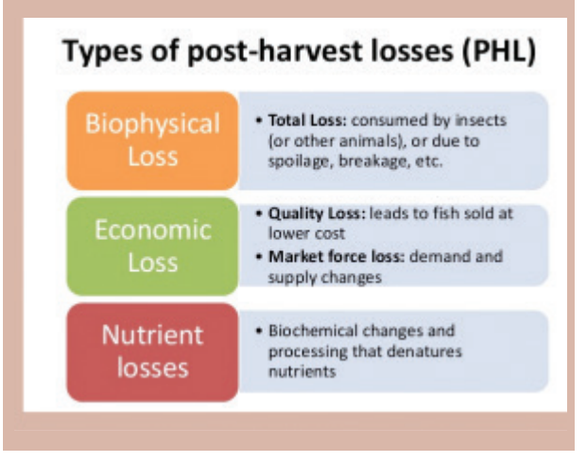
6.2 Methods of Food Preservation

Food preservation methods can be classified as follows

I. Physical Methods

A. Preservation by low temperatures
   1. Refrigeration
   2. Freezing
B. Preservation by high temperature
   1. Pasteurization
   2. Canning

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